

Chapter 27 — Biconsonantal / Geminate Disambiguation Drill

BBH Chapters 25 & 27 · Niphal and Hiphil Weak Verbs

For each form: (1) identify the stem (Niphal or Hiphil); (2) parse — conjugation, PGN; (3) identify the weak class (Biconsonantal or Geminate); (4) give the root and translate. Biconsonantal and Geminate forms are vocally identical — root knowledge is required. Answer key is on the last page.

Biconsonantal (II-ו/ה): medial vowel letter ו or י retained in stem (e.g. וּכְנַח, שָׁמַח, בָּרַח, בָּרַח, בָּרַח). Geminate (R2=R3): same consonant at R2 and R3; no medial vowel letter (e.g. סָבַב, מָמַח, מָמַח). Both classes share: Niphal perfect נָ (qamets); Hiphil perfect הָ (tsere); Hiphil imperfect יָ (qamets); Hiphil imperative הָ (qamets); Hiphil participle מָ (tsere).

Part A — Niphal: Biconsonantal vs. Geminate

All forms are Niphal. Identify whether each is Biconsonantal (medial ו/ה) or Geminate (R2=R3). The prefix vowel pattern (נָ in perfect; יָ in imperfect) is identical for both classes.

#	Form	Ref	Context	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Class	Root
1	נָכַח	Gen 41:32	"the thing is ___ by God"					
2	נָסַב	1 Kgs 7:24	"the gourds ___ it, ten to a					
3	יָכַח	Psa 93:2	"your throne ___ from of old"					
4	יָסַב	Num 21:4	"they traveled ___ Mount Edom"					
5	הָכַח	Psa 57:8	"my heart is ___, O God"					
6	הָסַב	Num 34:4	"your border ___ from the					
7	נָשַׁב	Lam 3:40	"let us examine and ___ to the					
8	נָתַח	1 Sam 3:12	"when I ___ what I have					

Part B — Hiphil: Biconsonantal vs. Geminate

All forms are Hiphil. Hiphil prefix patterns: הָ (perfect) · יָ (imperfect) · הָ (imperative) · מָ (participle). These are identical for Biconsonantal and Geminate — root knowledge is the only distinguisher.

#	Form	Ref	Context	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Class	Root
9	הָקַח	Gen 6:18	"I will ___ my covenant with					
10	הָסַב	2 Sam 2:22	"___ from following me"					
11	יָקַח	Deut 18:15	"the LORD will ___ a prophet"					
12	יָסַב	Eccl 1:6	"the wind ___ to the south"					
13	הָקַח	Deut 27:26	"___ the words of this law"					
14	הָסַב	2 Sam 2:22	"___ from following me"					
15	מָקַח	1 Sam 2:8	"He ___ the poor from the dust"					
16	מָסַב	Jer 21:4	"I am turning around the					

Part C — Mixed: Stem and Class Both Unknown

Identify both the stem (Niphal/Hiphal/Qal/Hophal) and the class. Part C includes Qal and Hophal forms as distractors — not every Biconsonantal form is Niphal or Hiphal.

#	Form	Ref	Context	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Class	Root
17	נִמּוֹג	Isa 14:31	"all Philistia ____"					
18	הִמָּטוּ	Deu 1:28	"our brothers ____ our hearts"					
19	יָרָם	Isa 52:13	"my servant shall be high and					
20	יָרָם	Psa 99:2	"great is the LORD, ____ above					
21	הִרָּיִם	Gen 14:22	"I have ____ my hand to the					
22	הוֹרָם	Lev 4:10	"just as it is ____ from the peace					
23	יָשׁוּב	Hos 14:8	"they ____ in the shade"					
24	יִשָּׁב	Lam 1:11	"all her people ____ to find					

Reflection Questions

- Items 1 (נִיכָן) and 2 (נִבְסָן) have the same נ prefix. What is the only reliable way to identify נִיכָן as Biconsonantal (root נִיכ) and נִבְסָן as Geminate (root נִבְס)?
- Items 9 (מִי־קָה) and 10 (מִי־סָה) both have ה־ prefix (tsere). One retains a medial vowel letter; the other shows a contracted stem. Describe precisely what the medial position of each form looks like and how that reflects the root structure.
- Items 11 (מִי־קָי) and 12 (מִי־בָי) are both Hiphal imperfect 3ms. You encounter an unknown form יִלְדִּי. What question must you ask to determine if it is Biconsonantal or Geminate?
- Items 19 (מִי־רָי) and 21 (מִי־רָה) come from the same root (מִי־ר) but differ in stem. What vowel under R2 distinguishes the Niphal imperfect from the Hiphal perfect?
- Item 22 (מִי־רָה) was classified as Hophal. How does the Hophal Biconsonantal prefix (מִי־רָה) differ from Niphal (מִי־רָה) and Hiphal (מִי־רָה), and what does it tell you about the semantics?

Answer Key

#	Form	Stem	Answer
1	נָכֹן	Niphal	Perfect/Ptc · 3ms/ms · Biconsonantal · נִּכּוּן — "is established / firm" — נִּ prefix (qamets); medial ו vowel
2	נָסַב	Niphal	Perfect · 3ms · Geminate · נִּבְּסָ — "encircled / went around" — נִּ prefix (qamets); R2=R3=ב = Geminate;
3	יִכּוֹן	Niphal	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יִכּוּן — "is established" — יִּ + dagesh in כּ + holem-vav = Niphal
4	יִסַּב	Niphal	Imperfect · 3ms · Geminate · יִבְּסָ — "went around" — יִּ + dagesh in ס (R2=R3 doubled) + holem =
5	הִכּוֹן	Niphal	Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · הִכּוּן — "is ready / prepared" — הִּ + dagesh + holem-vav = Niphal
6	הִסַּב	Niphal	Perfect · 3ms · Geminate · הִבְּסָ — "turned / went around" — הִּ + dagesh in ס (R2=R3) + holem = Niphal
7	נָשׁוּב	Niphal	Cohortative · 1cp · Biconsonantal · נִּבּוּשׁ — "let us return" — נִּ prefix + medial ו = Niphal Biconsonantal;
8	נִתָּם	Niphal	Inf. Const. · — · Geminate · נִתְּמָ — "to be completed / finished" — נִּ prefix + holem = Niphal Geminate
9	הִקִּים	Hiphil	Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · הִקֵּם — "established / raised up" — הִּ prefix (tsere) = Hiphil; medial ו vowel
10	הִסִּב	Hiphil	Perfect · 3ms · Geminate · הִבְּסָ — "turned aside" — הִּ prefix (tsere) = Hiphil; no medial vowel letter,
11	יִקִּים	Hiphil	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יִקֵּם — "will raise up" — יִּ prefix (qamets) = Hiphil Biconsonantal
12	יִסִּב	Hiphil	Imperfect · 3ms · Geminate · יִבְּסָ — "causes to go around / turns" — יִּ prefix (qamets) = Hiphil; no
13	הִקֵּם	Hiphil	Imperative · 2ms · Biconsonantal · הִקֵּם — "raise up! / confirm!" — הִּ prefix (qamets) = Hiphil imperative;
14	הִסִּב	Hiphil	Imperative · 2ms · Geminate · הִבְּסָ — "turn aside!" — הִּ prefix (qamets) = Hiphil imperative; same vowels
15	מִקִּים	Hiphil	Participle · ms · Biconsonantal · מִקֵּם — "one who raises up" — מִּ prefix (tsere) = Hiphil participle; medial ו
16	מִסִּב	Hiphil	Participle · ms · Geminate · מִבְּסָ — "turning / surrounding" — מִּ prefix (tsere) = Hiphil participle; no
17	נִמּוּג	Niphal	Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · נִמּוּג — "melted / dissolved" — נִּ prefix + medial ו = Niphal Biconsonantal;
18	הִמָּסָ	Hiphil	Perfect · 3cp · Geminate · הִמָּסָ — "caused to melt" — הִּ prefix (tsere) = Hiphil; R2=R3=ס = Geminate;
19	יִרָם	Niphal	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יִרָם — "will be exalted / lifted up" — יִּ prefix + qibbutz under R2
20	יִרָם	Niphal	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יִרָם — "is exalted / high" — יִּ prefix + holem under R2 = Niphal
21	הִרָם	Hiphil	Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · הִרָם — "lifted up / swore an oath" — הִּ prefix (tsere) + chiriq-yod = Hiphil
22	הוּרָם	Hophal	Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · הוּרָם — "was lifted off / removed" — הוּהִ prefix (holem-vav) = Hophal
23	יָשׁוּב	Qal	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יָשׁוּב — "will dwell / return" — Qal Biconsonantal — no Niphal נ or Hiphil
24	יָשַׁב	Qal	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יָשַׁב — "returned / went around" — Qal Biconsonantal; holem vowel